



Sony Ericsson just announced, another phone up for release soon is the basic Walkman phone W205.



The D888 has one slot for your international sim card and another slot to hold the SIM card of a carrier of your choice

Immediately, the screen seems small. The number keypad is designed well and the keys are large and well spaced out. Key feedback is good, but not excellent. That being said SMS' are a breeze. The call buttons are also large and well spaced out and nicely backlit. Directly above these are the menu buttons which offer good tactile feedback. The four-way joypad is in fact a thin metal bezel around a large red centre button. Although the directional buttons aren't the easiest to use, the centre button works well thanks to its large size and bevelled profile. The menu system is simple and intuitive. The volume and camera buttons are also tactile enough and not as hard as the buttons on the Motoyuva A810.

At first glance, the menus look very crisp and the text font used is really clear, although it's overlarge.

The camera is 3.2-megapixel and although it offers better imaging than the Motoyuva A810, that's not saying much. Music playback isn't as good and we found the proprietary headphone jack an annoyance. In fact the phone charges from the same port meaning that you cannot use the headset while its charging – an inconvenience. Signal reception is a bit shy of what we term as fair. At Rs.

8,750, we wouldn't recommend this phone; unless you want a phone with a good keypad at around the Rs. 9,000 mark.

LG KS360

A neat, compact handset this phone has a neon-green and white colour scheme that immediately attracts, but is not garish. The body is plastic but the unit is built well and nothing seems tacky. The screen is good and crisp and the menu icons look sharp – better than the icons on the Samsung Pixon which is praise indeed, since the latter is nearly three times this one's price. The menu and call buttons are well placed and intuitive. The joypad is unique with well-spaced directional keys and a small middle button.



LG KM330

While it makes the phone look different, it's also a major annoyance and an ergonomic flaw. Navigating the menus and options led us soon to discover how downright irritating those spaced directional buttons can be; our fingers were always reaching out over other buttons just to change the direction of our scroll, or to highlight an option. Despite the reasonably slim design there's a full-size QWERTY keypad that slides

out from the right side. However the keys are too hard for rigorous use and this keypad is more gimmicky than anything. Another negative – close the keypad and you cannot type since there is no number pad and no touchscreen! A touchscreen would have solved the ergonomics of typing out numbers on a QWERTY keypad. Typing out longer messages and mails takes a lot of practice and seems pointless given that the keys are too tiny, hard, and do not offer sufficient feedback. We feel it's a neat little phone that has its ergonomics all wrong. Its camera is also pretty ordinary and although music quality is decent the loudspeaker is not. LG chose proprietary headset connectivity so your 3.5-mm headphones are out.

At Rs. 9,999 LG has crammed quite a few features on to this phone but they seem to have done so without serious thought to usability.

Features that do not add up to the experience are not really features at all and the KS360, while being a really neat looking and reasonably feature-rich handset, has too many imperfections for us to seriously consider recommending it to anyone. If it had a touchscreen thrown in for its price, we would think differently.

Motorola ROKR E6

The E6 is a solidly built phone with a square profile that gives it a masculine edge. The rear of the unit is entirely metal and the phone is very well

built with great quality of materials



LG KS360

used. Its Linux-based and has an Intel XScale CPU to power things. Despite this the interface is not always snappy but suffices for the more mundane tasks. The

resource intensive applications such as games, camera usage, video recording and playback suffer lag under this hardware. It's a touchscreen and Motorola provides a superbly built stylus that is long enough to be held as a pencil – something that most vendors neglect. After all no matter how small the phone one's fingers remain the same size. The menu and call buttons are well laid out and typically flat with hardly any button travel like most Motorola's. The onscreen keyboard is very tiny and not usable enough to be termed as even passably ergonomic. Typing even a short SMS is a pain in the rear

HOW WE TESTED

First we log all the phones' specifications — this includes the network support, physical specifications, operating system, phone features, camera features, connectivity options and accessories provided. The logged features are then given weights when deciding on a total score for the features section. We rate only those features which we feel add to the phone's usability or productivity in some way. Therefore while we do not assign points to these fields any weight, we would definitely give marks for the presence of Wi-Fi and Bluetooth. We also do not rate any feature that is actually tested in the performance section — for

example, a smartphone is not given extra points for it having a higher megapixel camera, because the camera quality is tested and the one with better photographs will get more points. We would however, rate the settings available for the camera, since this is something that is impossible to test.

Ergonomics is also rated, as is build quality — the choice of materials used, keypad and battery cover quality. We also look at the layout of the keypad and menu buttons, and rate them on the basis of comfort and ease of use. Next, we rate the software interface and the menu system on its intuitiveness.

Before each of the tests we ensure that the cellphone has been reset to its factory settings and that no data is present in the multimedia folders and all messages have been deleted. This is to ensure uniformity. We have also used a fixed Vodafone SIM card throughout the test. Our signal strength test is conducted in two zones. Zone 1 is within our building with signal strength usually between 80 and 90 per cent. Zone 2 is inside our basement, and this zone generally kills signals. Inside zone 2 exists a spot where Vodafone has no signal at all and we also test the phones here to check the time it

takes for them to disconnect from a call. Voice clarity is tested in both zones. Handsfree clarity and loudspeaker volume are tested in zone 1. The performance tests are aimed at ascertaining the quality of the antenna built into the phone. No two handsets offer the same quality unless they use the exact model of antenna. We also rate the quality of the loudspeaker and its volume. The handsfree kit is also tested both on call and using a music file. If a phone has Wi-Fi, we test the signal strength at a fixed distance from our test PC with a wireless router. For Bluetooth, we transfer a file and note the time taken for the transfer.